

No, **you cannot just take a regular reference document and rename it SKILL.md**. Claude will completely ignore it if you do.

Claude requires a specific **YAML frontmatter block** at the absolute top of the file so it knows when to trigger the skill. [1, 2]

If you want to use a raw reference document, you have two options:

Option 1: Turn the document into a Skill (Add Frontmatter)

You must paste this exact formatting block at the very top of your document, above your normal text: [1]

```
---
name: your-skill-name
description: Explicitly tell Claude when to open and read this specific document.
---

[Paste your raw reference document text here]
```

Option 2: Put it in a references/ folder (The Better Way)

If you don't want to change your raw document at all, keep your document exactly as it is, but structure your files like this: [1, 3]

```
my-skill-name/
├── SKILL.md
└── references/
    └── your-raw-document.txt
```

Then, you just write a tiny SKILL.md file that tells Claude to read that specific document when needed: [3]

```
---
name: document-reader
description: Use when the user asks about the topics inside my reference document.
---

Read the file located at `references/your-raw-document.txt` to answer the user's prompt.
```

Would you like help writing the exact **description** metadata for your specific document so Claude triggers it correctly? [1, 4]

[1] <https://agentskills.io>

[2] <https://www.mdskills.ai>

[3] <https://www.skillsdirectory.com>

[4] <https://learn.microsoft.com>